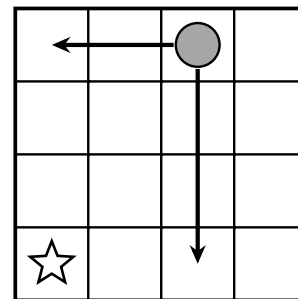
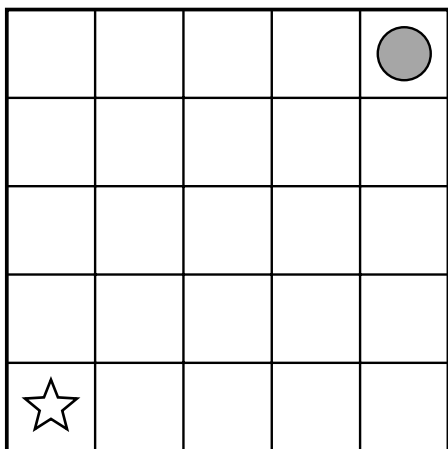


Players take turns. On a board, a move slides the token straight left or straight down, toward the star's side, one or more squares. Whoever moves the token onto the star wins.

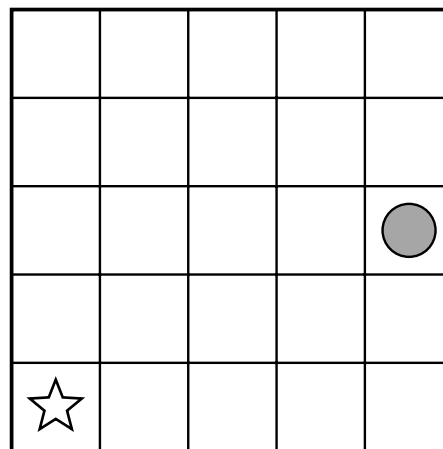
In a game with piles of counters, a move takes one or more counters from one pile. Whoever takes the last counter wins.



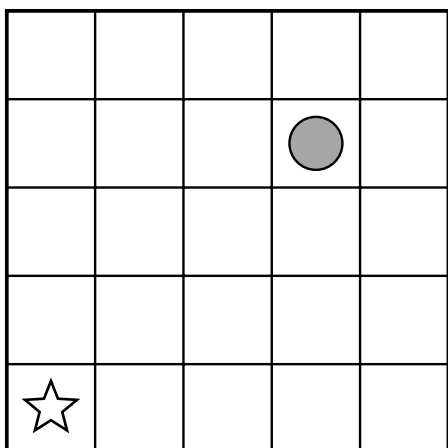
**Problem 1:** Play many games on a 5-by-5 board from each of these starting squares. Would you rather go first or second?



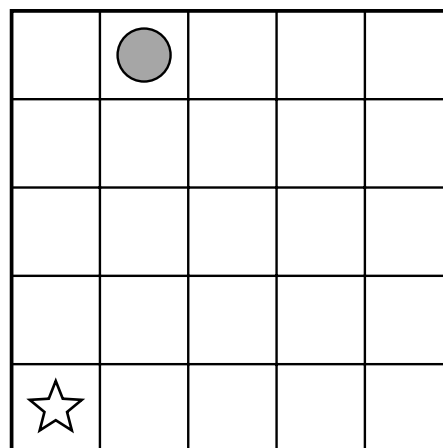
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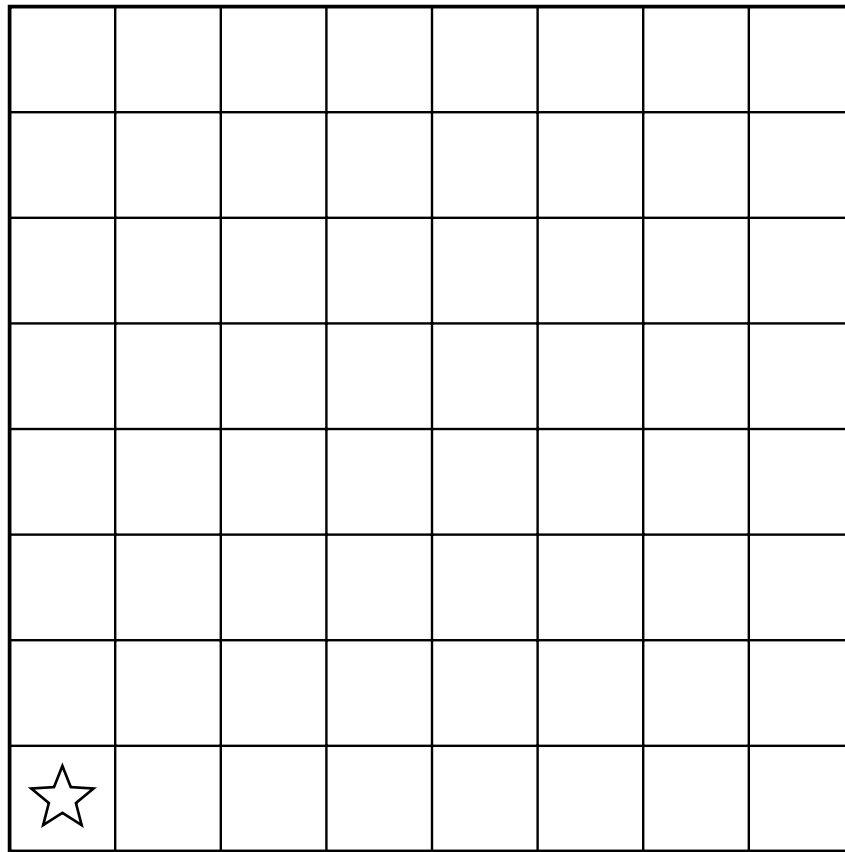


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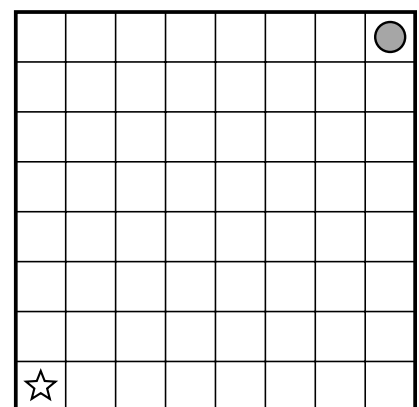


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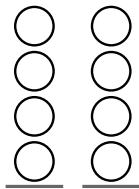
**Problem 2:** Color every square of this 8-by-8 board except the star. Color a square green if you would rather go first when the token starts there, and red if you would rather go second.



**Problem 3:** Your partner goes first, with the token in the top-right corner of an 8-by-8 board. Explain how you can always win, however your partner moves.

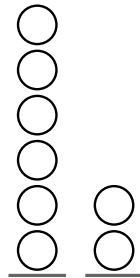


**Problem 4:** Play many games with two piles of counters from each start. Would you rather go first or second?



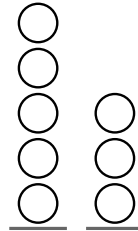
4 and 4

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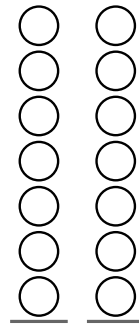
6 and 2

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5 and 3

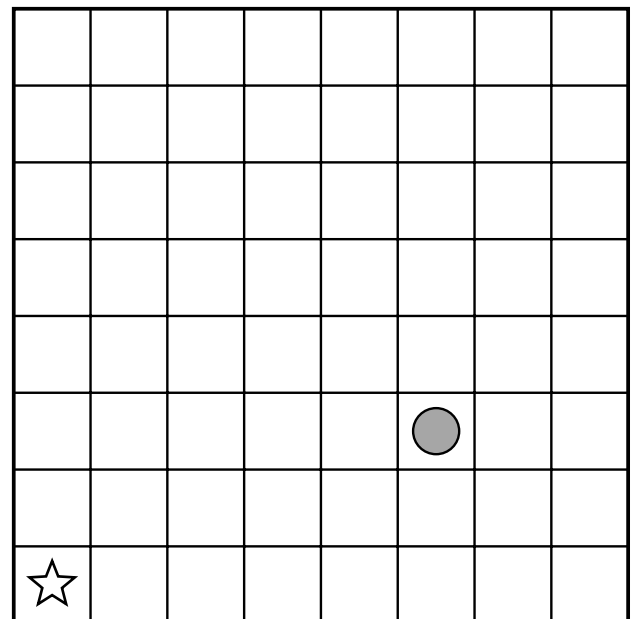
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7 and 7

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**Problem 5:** Which two piles of counters make the same game as this 8-by-8 board with the token on the dot? Explain how each move on the board matches a move with the piles.



**Problem 6:** A game starts with piles of 52 and 37 counters. Would you rather go first or second? Explain how you can always win, however the other player moves.

**Problem 7:** Play many games with three piles from each start. Would you rather go first or second?



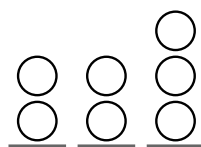
1, 1, 1

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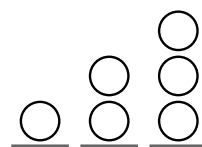
1, 1, 2

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2, 2, 3

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1, 2, 3

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**Problem 8:** Find every start with three piles, each with 1, 2 or 3 counters, where you would rather go second. The order of the piles does not matter. Explain how you know you have found them all.

**Problem 9:** Find all the starts with three piles, each with 1 to 6 counters, where you would rather go second. The order of the piles does not matter.